THE WITNESS AND THE STATE

The Chosen Witness, Political Power, Institutional Responsibility, Exile and the Struggle for Accountability

An evidence-linked documentary and philosophical examination

Authorial method: Impartial AI-assisted documentary examination incorporating first-person testimony, publicly available official records, documents preserved in the author's archive, institutional correspondence, and clearly labelled philosophical and spiritual interpretation.

Governing principles: Preservation first. Examination second. Conclusion last.

Evidence principle: The record stays free. Faith is not a finding.

Scope limitation: This is an examination, not a court, a criminal verdict, or a determination that every allegation is proven.

Part I — The question of the witness

Chapter 1. The public question: what happens when a vulnerable individual confronts an institutionally powerful state?

The central question of The Witness and the State is not whether one individual's account should automatically prevail over the account of a government, a police service, a hospital, a disability-support provider, an insurer, a lawyer, or a family member. Nor is it whether the existence of an official document automatically proves that the institution acted lawfully, fairly, or humanely. The question is how an individual's account can be examined when the individual describes a prolonged experience of financial insecurity, disability-related dependency, exclusion, legal vulnerability, institutional correspondence, family estrangement, police involvement, hospitalisation, and a continuing search for accountability.

The individual at the centre of this examination identifies publicly as Barran Dodger and Dr Richard William McLean. His account combines events that he says occurred directly to him, documents that he says preserve parts of those events, interpretations he has formed from their timing and relationships, and spiritual language through which he understands survival and suffering. Those different elements cannot responsibly be collapsed into a single category. An email can establish that words were written and

sent if its provenance and transmission are verified. It cannot, by itself, establish every claim made in the email. An administrative decision can establish what an agency decided, and sometimes the reasons it gave. It does not necessarily establish that every disputed event described by the applicant occurred exactly as alleged. A person's testimony can be indispensable evidence of lived experience without automatically proving the identity, intention, or coordination of every person whom the witness suspects.

This distinction is not a means of silencing the witness. It is the condition that makes the examination credible.

The public record establishes that Bill Shorten served as Australia's Minister for the National Disability Insurance Scheme and Minister for Government Services from 1 June 2022 until 20 January 2025. The official parliamentary biography and government announcements establish that ministerial role. They provide a legitimate starting point for examining the responsibilities of the portfolio and the public obligations associated with it. They do not, without additional evidence, establish that Shorten personally directed a particular police attendance, hospital decision, insurance determination, family dispute, or service-provider decision involving McLean.

That distinction matters because ministerial responsibility and personal operational direction are different propositions. A minister may have policy responsibility, statutory powers, parliamentary accountability, and oversight relationships with agencies within a portfolio. Whether a minister personally intervened in an individual case is a separate factual question requiring evidence of the intervention itself: a letter, instruction, meeting record, communication, decision record, reliable witness account, or other material that connects the minister to the particular act. The fact that an event occurred during a minister's tenure is relevant to chronology; it is not sufficient proof that the minister caused it.

The same standard must apply in both directions. An institution should not be condemned solely because an individual suffered while dealing with it. Equally, an individual should not be dismissed solely because the account is complicated, emotionally forceful, contested, or associated with a history of mental-health treatment. The proper response is to examine the records, preserve the chronology, identify what each source can establish, and state openly what remains unknown.

Chapter 2. The archive as a record of a search for answers

McLean has assembled a public archive containing correspondence, administrative documents, complaints, legal materials, personal statements, and authored analyses.

The main archive is available at the Barrandodger GitHub repository, with a public-facing archive website and a separate Official Government Documents Register.

The existence of these collections is itself relevant to understanding the form of the witness's response. Instead of relying exclusively on recollection, McLean has attempted to preserve material in a form that other people can inspect. The archive contains documents whose filenames indicate correspondence with government agencies, public-interest disclosures, NDIS decisions, complaints, housing and support requests, hospital-related correspondence, guardianship matters, and police-related records. The filename and location of a document help readers locate it; neither substitutes for reading the document and checking its provenance.

Several records are particularly relevant to the documentary investigation and should be examined in their original form:

- **Commonwealth Ombudsman complaint dated 15 November 2021. The investigation must establish the complaint's exact contents, the issues raised, the response received, and any recorded disposition. The existence of a complaint establishes that a complaint document was preserved; it does not establish that every allegation within it was accepted.**
- **Federal Court PID assessment dated 27 March 2023. The actual assessment must be read to identify its jurisdiction, the decision made, the reasons provided, and what that decision did or did not determine.**
- **Notification dated 18 June 2023 concerning a decision not to allocate a disclosure. The document's operative language and reasons are essential. A decision not to allocate a disclosure must not be inaccurately represented as a finding that the disclosure was true, false, malicious, or proven.**
- **NDIA decision concerning a SIL request dated 1 June 2023. This should be examined for the requested support, the decision-maker, the stated rationale, the review rights, and any later decisions.**
- **Letter to NDIA Chief Executive Officer Rebecca Faulksingham dated 7 January 2024, as titled in the archive. The exact name, text, delivery evidence, and any response should be verified from the underlying record rather than inferred from the filename.**
- **NDIS plan approval dated 20 November 2025. This may be important to the later support chronology, but the plan's actual terms must be checked before drawing conclusions about available funding or the adequacy of support.**
- **Anglicare safety assessment dated 1 December 2025. This should be read to establish what risks were recorded, by whom, when, and what action was recommended or taken.**
- **Police matter legal documents dated 20 January 2026. The exact documents within this file, their authors, and their legal status must be identified before they are used to describe any police action or court outcome.**
- **Accommodation request concerning SIL/SDA dated 20 January 2026. This may**

> help document the request for suitable accommodation, but its contents and subsequent response must be examined directly.

These records should be read alongside the archive's rebuild site and the main archive repository. The repository contains both documentary materials and authored interpretations. Those categories should remain separate throughout the investigation. A document written by McLean can be a valuable record of what he believed, reported, requested, or experienced at a particular time. It is not independent corroboration of every allegation contained in it merely because it is preserved as a PDF.

The proper method is therefore neither to accept the archive wholesale nor to dismiss it wholesale. It is to create a source-by-source account: identify the document, record its date and author, quote its operative language accurately, establish whether it was received by the intended institution, identify the response, and explain exactly what conclusion the material supports.

The next section of the manuscript must examine the email titled "Death threat to Bill Shorten," the police and court chronology, the alleged AVO proceedings, the legal-aid experience, and the relationship between McLean's account and the surviving primary records. Those questions are central and must be treated in detail, without converting allegations into established findings.

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Continued manuscript — Part II

Chapter 3. The email titled "Death threat to Bill Shorten": language, context, intention and consequence

3.1 The title and the account of its intended meaning

McLean identifies an email carrying the subject line "Death threat to Bill Shorten" as a central event in his account of the relationship between political authority, personal desperation, and the struggle to obtain an institutional response. His explanation is that the subject line was intended as a provocative play on words, designed to force attention to what he regarded as a life-threatening accumulation of administrative, financial, disability-support, and personal injustices. He says that he had sent numerous communications without receiving the response he considered necessary and that he used the subject line to make the seriousness of his circumstances impossible to overlook.

That is McLean's account of his intention. The intention must be tested against the complete email, its surrounding correspondence, the recipients' records, any contemporaneous explanation, and the subsequent police and court documents. A subject line is important evidence of how a message could be interpreted, but it is not a substitute for the body of the message or the surrounding circumstances. Conversely, an explanation offered after an incident should be preserved and considered, but it cannot by itself settle how the original words would reasonably have been understood.

The first documentary task is to retrieve the original message in its complete form, including the subject, date and time, recipients, copied recipients, body, attachments, message headers where available, and preceding and subsequent correspondence. The second is to establish whether the message was delivered and to whom. The third is to identify how the recipients or any investigating authority described the message at the time, rather than relying only on later summaries.

The distinction between a threatening communication and a communication that uses alarming language to demand attention is not resolved by the subject line alone. Nor should the interpretation be determined merely by the author's later characterisation. The words, context, intent, recipient, and applicable law must be examined together.

3.2 The substantive grievances described in the email

According to McLean, the email did not consist solely of its provocative subject line. He says that its body described financial and administrative grievances, set out possible solutions, and attempted to bring several unresolved matters to the attention of people with relevant responsibilities.

His account identifies several separate strands:

1. WorkCover and compensation. McLean says that his workers' compensation history formed part of the circumstances he was trying to explain. The documentary examination must distinguish the existence of a claim from any later determination, the amount paid or refused, the reasons for a decision, and any legal or administrative review.

2. Financial consequences of a former relationship. McLean says that a former fiancé or partner exercised financial control over him and that the consequences remained relevant to his later circumstances. This must be assessed through contemporaneous financial records, correspondence, agreements, account records, and any relevant legal findings. A description of a relationship as coercive is important testimony, but any specific allegation about another person's conduct requires appropriate evidence.

3. Total and permanent disability insurance. McLean says that an incorrect total and permanent disability payout contributed to his financial difficulties. The inquiry must establish the applicable policy, the claim lodged, the insurer's decision, the calculation of any benefit, and the records supporting his assertion that the outcome was incorrect.

4. HCF income protection. McLean says that HCF denied an income-protection claim that he regarded as legitimate. The necessary records include the policy wording, claim documents, medical and employment evidence relevant to the claim, the insurer's reasons, internal review correspondence, and any external dispute-resolution outcome. The mere fact of a denial does not establish that it was wrongful; equally, the fact that an insurer issued a denial does not establish that the decision was correct.

5. A petition to Parliament House. McLean says that he had lodged or delivered a petition and possessed a receipt number. The petition, receipt, submission date, receiving office, and any formal response should be examined. If the petition addressed the same issues later described in the email, the chronology could help establish that the grievances predated the disputed communication.

6. Complaints to oversight and disability agencies. McLean says that he sent the email or related material to the Independent Broad-based Anti-corruption Commission, the Commonwealth Ombudsman, Rebecca Faulksingham, whom he identifies as the NDIA chief executive at the time, and police. Each recipient and each transmission must be verified separately. Sending the same message to multiple institutions would not, by itself, prove that any recipient accepted its contents or had jurisdiction to investigate every issue raised.

These are not interchangeable disputes. An insurance claim, a workers' compensation matter, a complaint about public administration, an NDIS support decision, and a police investigation operate under different legal and administrative frameworks. A rigorous account must reconstruct each one independently before asking whether the combined effect created a pattern of disadvantage.

3.3 The distinction between a message's meaning and its consequences

McLean's account places considerable weight on the consequences he says followed the email. He describes police attendance, being taken to a police station, and subsequent court proceedings. He interprets the sequence as evidence of a profound imbalance between an individual attempting to obtain assistance and a politically powerful public figure whom he believed had been threatened or challenged.

The temporal sequence is relevant: if the email preceded police action, the dates may help establish a connection between the communication and the subsequent response. But temporal sequence alone does not establish who initiated the police action, what information the police received, what legal basis they relied upon, or whether any politician personally contacted or directed them.

The records required to answer these questions include the original email; any complaint or referral concerning it; police event and attendance records; arrest or detention documentation, if applicable; interview records; charging documents; bail or intervention-order applications; court listings; and the final court disposition. Each record answers a different question. A police event number establishes the existence of a recorded event, not necessarily the truth of every account recorded in it. A charge records an allegation formally brought by the state, not a conviction. An intervention order records a legal process and its terms; it does not automatically prove that the respondent committed a criminal offence.

The central question is not whether the consequences felt severe to McLean. His account makes clear that he experienced them as frightening and life-altering. The documentary question is whether the response was lawful, proportionate, procedurally fair, and supported by the information available to the relevant decision-makers at the time.

3.4 The public-interest question

If the email was an attempt to bring unresolved administrative grievances to the attention of authorities, its substantive complaints should not disappear from examination simply because its subject line attracted a police response. If the language was reasonably interpreted as a threat, that interpretation and the grounds for it must also be examined. Neither question automatically cancels the other.

A fair investigation would ask whether the recipients separated the substance of the complaints from the wording of the subject line; whether the grievances were referred to the appropriate agencies; whether McLean was given an opportunity to explain his meaning; and whether any police or court process followed the relevant legal requirements. It would also ask whether the agencies had authority to investigate the particular matters referred to them and whether their decisions were communicated with sufficient reasons.

The documentary record must determine the answers. It would be premature to describe the incident as proven political persecution, and equally premature to conclude that the existence of a police response made the underlying financial and

administrative grievances irrelevant.

The source currently identifiable in the public archive is the repository itself: Barrandodger archive. The full original email has not been independently examined in the material available for this section. Accordingly, the account above preserves McLean's explanation without claiming that the exact wording, full recipient list, transmission history, or official interpretation has yet been verified.

Chapter 4. Police attendance, arrest, and the alleged Moorabbin Magistrates' Court proceedings

4.1 Reconstructing the sequence

McLean says that police attended after the email incident, took him to a police station, and that he subsequently had to appear in proceedings at Moorabbin Magistrates' Court involving an intervention order or an application described in his account as an AVO. He interprets the sequence as an example of institutional power being applied against a person who was already experiencing financial and psychological vulnerability.

The first requirement is to establish the precise chronology. The terms police attendance, arrest, detention, interview, charge, summons, intervention-order application, and court appearance are not synonyms. They describe different events with different legal consequences. A person may be taken to a station without being charged; a charge may be laid without a conviction; and an intervention-order application may proceed separately from a criminal prosecution.

For that reason, the account should not use "arrested" as a settled legal description until the relevant record confirms that an arrest occurred. If McLean was arrested, the record should establish the alleged offence, the arresting officers, the time, the stated grounds, the custody period, and the subsequent procedural steps. If he was instead asked to attend, detained under another power, or transported in different circumstances, the manuscript must describe that accurately.

The same precision applies to the court proceedings. The court file should identify the case type, the applicant, the protected person or persons, the respondent, the statutory basis, the order sought, the interim arrangements if any, the final terms, and the outcome. The date of each hearing matters. So do any variations, withdrawals, dismissals, undertakings, or later orders.

The public archive contains a file titled Police Matter Legal Documents, dated 20 January 2026. That filename identifies a relevant source for retrieval. It does not

establish that the file contains the original Moorabbin proceedings, that the proceedings ended in a particular way, or that the documents prove misconduct. Those questions require examination of the actual pages and, where necessary, the official court record.

4.2 The meaning and limits of an intervention order

McLean describes the alleged proceedings as an AVO intended to protect Bill Shorten from him. That description must be checked against the actual court documents. In Victoria, intervention-order terminology and procedures differ from the terminology used in New South Wales, and the relevant legal framework depends on the nature of the application and the proceedings. A later recollection may use "AVO" as a general term even where the original case used a different statutory name.

An intervention order can impose significant restrictions on a respondent. Its existence may affect where a person can go, whom they can contact, and how they conduct themselves. It can therefore have serious practical and emotional consequences. However, an order is not, by itself, a criminal conviction. Nor does the mere fact that an order was sought prove that the protected person, the applicant, the police, or the respondent acted dishonestly.

A sound analysis must distinguish at least four possible findings:

- **An order was applied for.**
- **An interim or final order was made, with specified terms.**
- **A criminal charge was brought in connection with the events.**
- **A court made a finding of guilt, or the charge ended through another identified process.**

These propositions require different sources. They should not be merged into a single statement that McLean was guilty, that Shorten was endangered, or that the proceedings were an abuse of power.

The appropriate question is whether the process complied with the law and whether the court had accurate and sufficient information. If McLean believes the process was unfair, the examination should identify the specific procedural defect alleged, the evidence supporting that claim, the decision-maker responsible, and any review or appeal mechanism that was available.

4.3 The allegation of political influence

McLean's wider interpretation is that the political status of Shorten materially affected

the response he experienced. He has described Shorten as possessing wealth, influence, and access to government, and he sees the police and court sequence as part of an asymmetry between a minister and an NDIS participant.

The power imbalance is a legitimate subject for public-interest analysis. A government minister has a public platform and formal responsibilities that an individual disability-support participant does not possess. The individual may also depend on agencies and services that are difficult to navigate without money, legal assistance, stable housing, or practical support. These differences can affect a person's ability to challenge decisions, preserve evidence, or obtain timely advice.

But structural inequality and personal direction are different claims. The fact that a minister held a powerful office does not demonstrate that the minister instructed police to act in a particular case. That specific allegation requires a traceable evidentiary connection: for example, a communication, a referral showing the origin of the complaint, a reliable witness account, or another primary record demonstrating contact or intervention.

The official parliamentary biography establishes Shorten's ministerial role during the relevant period. It is an appropriate source for the public-office chronology, not proof of involvement in McLean's police matter. See the Australian Parliament biography and the NDIA announcement welcoming the new minister in June 2022.

The investigation should therefore pursue two questions independently. First, was the police and court process itself lawful and fair? Second, is there evidence that any person outside the ordinary process improperly influenced it? The first question can be answered from the procedural record even if the second remains unresolved.

4.4 What the witness says the experience meant

McLean's testimony presents the police and court events not as an isolated legal episode but as a turning point in a larger story of fear, insecurity, and loss of control. He says that he had been attempting to communicate accumulated grievances and instead found himself exposed to a process that he experienced as threatening to his freedom and future.

This emotional dimension belongs in the record. A documentary narrative need not strip a person's account of its human meaning in order to be rigorous. It should, however, make clear the distinction between an experience and the explanation later attached to it. Fear can be real even when the cause remains disputed. The consequences of a court process can be serious even where the underlying allegations have not been

adjudicated. A person's perception of powerlessness is evidence of their experience; the cause of that powerlessness must be established through further examination.

The appropriate conclusion at this stage is therefore limited but important: McLean describes a police and court sequence that he experienced as a severe exercise of institutional power. The exact legal steps, the court's findings, and any evidence of political intervention remain matters for the primary record.

Chapter 5. Legal representation and the account of Graeme Wells

5.1 The alleged failure to obtain meaningful legal assistance

McLean identifies Graeme Wells, whom he associates with Legal Aid Victoria, as a significant figure in his account of the legal difficulties surrounding the police and court proceedings. McLean says that he raised numerous legal concerns but did not receive the assistance he believed he needed. He recalls being advised to attend the Magistrates' Court and speak with a court officer on the day of a proceeding involving an alleged threat to kill. He says that this left him afraid of the possibility of imprisonment and uncertain about how to protect his position.

These are serious allegations about access to justice. They require careful reconstruction, particularly because the consequences of inadequate legal assistance can be substantial for someone who is already struggling with disability, finances, housing, and institutional correspondence.

The first issue is identification. The relevant records must establish whether Graeme Wells was acting as a solicitor, a duty lawyer, a legal-aid employee, a referral contact, or in another capacity. His precise role matters because the responsibilities associated with different legal-service arrangements are not identical.

The second issue is the advice itself. McLean's recollection should be compared with contemporaneous emails, appointment records, file notes, letters, legal-aid eligibility decisions, court listings, and any written advice. If the advice was given orally, the date, circumstances, words remembered, and presence of any other person should be recorded. The absence of a written record would not automatically disprove that a conversation occurred, but it would affect what can be established independently.

The third issue is the practical effect. Did McLean have a lawyer on the hearing date? Was he eligible for legal aid? Was representation refused, unavailable, or deferred? Was he told to seek advice from a court officer about procedure rather than legal strategy? Did he understand the distinction? Did the court explain his options? Were any

adjournments or other procedural protections available?

These questions must be answered from the available evidence rather than from assumptions about what legal-aid services generally do.

5.2 The difference between procedural information and legal representation

A court officer may be able to explain administrative processes, courtroom arrangements, or the location of forms and services. That is different from advising a person about the merits of a charge, the interpretation of evidence, the risks of pleading guilty, or the strategy for contesting an allegation.

If McLean was advised to approach a court officer because no lawyer was available, the critical question is what assistance he had actually received and whether he understood what remained unresolved. If he faced a criminal charge and feared imprisonment, the adequacy of the advice should be assessed against the charge, the applicable law, the available legal services, and the circumstances of the hearing.

It would be improper to conclude that Wells committed professional misconduct merely because McLean reports feeling abandoned or frightened. It would be equally improper to dismiss McLean's concern without examining the file. A defensible finding would need to identify the relevant professional duty, the action or omission in question, the available evidence, and the effect on the client.

The documentary investigation should seek the legal-aid file, the relevant court record, correspondence with Wells, any written advice, and any complaint or response concerning the service. Where access is restricted by confidentiality or privacy rules, the manuscript should state that limitation rather than imply that inaccessible records confirm the allegation.

5.3 Legal vulnerability as part of the larger account

McLean's description of his experience highlights a broader problem: legal rights are not always practically accessible to people who lack money, stable accommodation, confidence in institutional processes, or adequate support. A person can possess a formal right to representation or review while struggling to exercise it effectively.

That concern is not unique to McLean, and it does not require a finding that any particular lawyer acted improperly. It raises a public-interest question about whether people facing consequential proceedings can understand the process, obtain suitable advice, and make informed decisions.

The witness's account should therefore be retained as testimony of his experience of legal vulnerability. A conclusion about professional fault must remain open until the underlying evidence is examined.

Chapter 6. Police attendance, hospitalisation, and the alleged loss of control over daily life

6.1 The account of repeated hospitalisation

McLean says that police had previously attended his home at night, that a door was forced or kicked in on one occasion, and that he was transported to hospital. He describes these events as part of a sequence of hospitalisations that he recalls as numbering approximately ten, eleven, or twelve by the relevant period.

The precise number is uncertain in the account presently available. It should not be converted into an exact statistic without medical records or a reliable chronology. Each hospitalisation should be recorded separately, with the date, facility, reason for attendance, circumstances of arrival, legal status, length of stay, and discharge arrangements where those details can be established.

Hospitalisation can occur in a range of circumstances. A police transport may be voluntary, requested by a health service, undertaken in response to an immediate concern, or associated with statutory powers. The fact that police transported someone to hospital does not, on its own, establish whether the action was justified or unjustified. That question depends on the circumstances and the legal authority relied upon.

McLean attributes aspects of this history to Shorten, alleging that the minister caused or arranged police intervention. The available material for this chapter does not establish that causal connection. The appropriate inquiry is whether any documentary evidence links Shorten or his office to a particular police attendance or hospital decision. In the absence of such evidence, the account must remain attributed to McLean rather than presented as an established finding.

6.2 The importance of records created at the time

Hospital and police records can clarify the sequence, although they must themselves be read critically. A medical record may contain direct observations, the patient's own statements, information supplied by another person, or a summary copied from an earlier entry. Those categories should not be treated as interchangeable.

For every relevant attendance, the investigation should ask:

- **Who initiated the contact?**
- **What reason was recorded for the attendance?**
- **What did the attending officers observe directly?**
- **What information was supplied by third parties?**
- **What legal authority, if any, was relied upon?**
- **What assessment was undertaken by health professionals?**
- **What restrictions were imposed, and for how long?**
- **What reasons were given for discharge or continued admission?**
- **What property, accommodation, or support arrangements existed at the time of discharge?**

These questions are particularly important when a person alleges that a hospital admission was connected to an external campaign against them. A chronology can establish whether different events occurred close together. It cannot, without more, establish that they were coordinated.

The archive includes several files titled as Goulburn Hospital chief executive briefings, including the briefing dated 11 November 2025 and subsequent files dated 14 November 2025, such as Goulburn Hospital CEO Briefing 2. These filenames indicate materials that may be relevant to later hospital-related concerns. They do not establish that the files concern the earlier events described in this chapter. Their contents and dates must be checked before they are used to support any particular proposition.

6.3 The reported experience of restraint and seclusion

McLean also describes an incident during a hospital stay in which, after making arrangements for accommodation and preparing to meet someone, nurses allegedly restrained him and placed him in a restrictive setting for several additional days. The term he used in recounting this incident is unclear in the available account; it may refer to seclusion or another intervention, but that cannot safely be assumed.

The terminology matters. Physical restraint, mechanical restraint, chemical restraint, and seclusion are distinct practices. Their legal requirements and clinical justification may differ according to the jurisdiction, setting, and date. The manuscript must use the term appearing in the contemporaneous record rather than substitute one based on an uncertain recollection.

The relevant questions include the recorded reason for the intervention, who authorised it, the observations and assessments that preceded it, the duration, the monitoring

undertaken, the review process, and the information given to McLean. If he believes the intervention was unnecessary or improperly prolonged, the claim should be assessed against the record and the applicable standards.

His assertion that Shorten manipulated or caused the incident is a separate allegation. The hospital record might establish what occurred within the facility, but a claim that a political figure caused it would require evidence connecting that figure to the decision. Without such evidence, the manuscript must not collapse the alleged hospital event and the alleged external cause into one proven narrative.

6.4 Why institutional transparency matters

Restrictive interventions are among the most consequential events that can occur in a health setting. They can affect a person's bodily autonomy, dignity, sense of safety, and trust in treatment. A person who reports an unexplained or frightening intervention deserves an opportunity to obtain the records, understand the rationale, and challenge an action where appropriate.

A responsible review should not assume that a health professional acted improperly merely because the patient disputes the decision. Nor should it assume that the decision was justified simply because it appears in a clinical record. The decision, reasons, authority, duration, and review must be examined.

For McLean, this issue is connected to a larger experience of losing control over the circumstances of his life. His testimony describes a series of events in which police, health services, accommodation, property, and personal relationships seemed to converge into a single experience of powerlessness. That experience is important to preserve. The causes of each event, however, must be investigated individually before a conclusion about coordination can be reached.

Chapter 7. Property, the car, the dog, and the journey to New South Wales

7.1 The account of departure

McLean says that, following hospitalisation and the loss or disruption of his previous living arrangements, he found himself having to leave with very limited resources. He recalls having approximately $50, his dog, and a car that he says had been obtained through a no-interest loan. He describes leaving Victoria and moving towards New South Wales under circumstances he experienced as desperate.

The significance of this account is not merely geographical. It describes a transition

from one support environment to another while the individual believed he lacked stable housing, sufficient money, reliable assistance, and control over important decisions affecting his future.

To reconstruct the circumstances, the investigation must identify the approximate departure date, the location from which McLean left, the legal status of his accommodation, the ownership and financing of the car, the arrangements for the dog, and the records showing where he stayed after departure. Bank statements, loan documentation, vehicle records, accommodation correspondence, support-provider records, and contemporaneous messages may help establish the chronology.

If the car was subject to a loan or other arrangement, the legal ownership and any later decision concerning its disposal must be checked rather than inferred. The archive contains a file titled NSW Trustee vehicle disposal decision, dated 14 November 2025. Its title suggests relevance to a later vehicle-related decision, but it does not establish that it concerns the same vehicle or the earlier departure. That connection must be verified from the document itself.

7.2 The role of the dog

McLean repeatedly identifies his dog as a companion and source of emotional continuity during periods of insecurity. The dog appears in his account not simply as property but as a relationship that remained present when other relationships and arrangements felt unreliable.

This distinction matters. For a person experiencing isolation or housing instability, an animal may be a central part of daily routine, emotional attachment, and the ability to feel safe. At the same time, suitable accommodation may depend on whether an animal is permitted, whether the environment is safe, and whether practical care arrangements can be maintained.

The manuscript should preserve McLean's account of the dog's importance without converting the relationship into evidence of an unrelated allegation. If he alleges that another person threatened the dog, the allegation should be linked to the original message or other contemporaneous evidence. If the claim cannot be independently verified, it should be described as his report.

7.3 Relocation and continuity of support

A move between states can disrupt medical care, accommodation, personal relationships, legal proceedings, and disability supports. Eligibility and service

arrangements may depend on the relevant scheme and circumstances, while the practical burden of coordinating them often falls on the person seeking assistance.

McLean's account describes relocation as an attempt to escape circumstances he regarded as intolerable. A documentary examination should identify what services he had before leaving, which services were discontinued or interrupted, what new services he sought, and how the transition was managed.

The existence of later NDIS records, accommodation requests, safety assessments, and guardianship-related documents makes this chronology important. Relevant materials include the NDIS plan approval dated 20 November 2025, the Anglicare safety assessment dated 1 December 2025, and the SIL/SDA accommodation request dated 20 January 2026.

These records should be examined in sequence to determine what support was requested, what was approved, what was provided, and what remained outstanding. They should not be treated as interchangeable proof of a single continuing institutional plan. Each decision may have had its own circumstances, reasons, and responsible decision-maker.

Chapter 8. Family estrangement, exclusion, and the experience of social death

8.1 The account of being excluded from family life

McLean describes a profound sense of separation from his family. He identifies his mother, April McLean, in connection with an intervention order that he says was obtained at police request and that, in his understanding, excluded him from the family environment. He also contrasts his circumstances with those of relatives whom he says lived in expensive homes with spare rooms while he experienced homelessness or slept in a car or park several kilometres away.

These are emotionally significant claims. They also contain distinct factual propositions that should not be merged. The existence and terms of any intervention order must be established from the relevant court record. The circumstances in which the application was made, the applicant's stated reasons, any police involvement, and the final outcome should be examined separately. The living circumstances of relatives, if relevant, should be documented only to the extent that reliable records or appropriate testimony support them.

The fact that a family member sought an order would not, by itself, establish that the family member acted maliciously. Nor would it establish that McLean's account of

estrangement was false. The legal process and the broader family relationship must be understood in their respective contexts.

8.2 The meaning of exclusion

McLean describes the experience in language of abandonment, exile, and being treated as though he were less than human. These expressions communicate the depth of his perceived rejection. They belong to the personal and philosophical dimension of the manuscript, although they should not be misrepresented as legal findings about his relatives' intentions.

Family relationships can become difficult or estranged for many reasons. The relevant evidence may be incomplete, contested, or held privately by people who do not wish to participate. A documentary account cannot assume that every relative had the same understanding of events or acted from the same motive.

The narrower and more defensible question is what McLean experienced, what events he says led to the estrangement, what documents record those events, and what practical consequences followed. If an order restricted contact or access to a home, its precise terms can establish the legal restriction. It cannot, without additional evidence, establish the entire emotional or moral meaning of the family relationship.

8.3 Housing, dignity, and comparative disadvantage

McLean's comparison between his own housing circumstances and the apparent resources available to his relatives expresses a question about the distribution of care. He asks why a person facing disability-related hardship could remain without a safe place to live while other people in his family appeared to have more space and resources.

The moral force of that question does not depend on proving that any relative had a legal duty to provide accommodation. Moral obligation, family expectation, and enforceable legal responsibility are different matters. The manuscript should not assume that relatives were legally required to house him without establishing the relevant circumstances and law.

Nevertheless, the account raises an important question about the lived experience of social protection. A person may be surrounded by institutions and still feel profoundly unsupported. A person may have relatives and still experience isolation. Formal services may exist while practical access to suitable accommodation remains unresolved.

McLean's testimony should be preserved as an account of that disjunction between the appearance of available resources and his own experience of deprivation. Any stronger conclusion about deliberate exclusion, coordinated action, or an intention to cause harm requires separate evidence.

8.4 The language of exile and social death

The concept of social death is used in different academic and philosophical contexts to describe the loss of recognition, participation, status, or meaningful social connection. In McLean's account, the term expresses his sense that he was no longer treated as a full participant in family and community life.

The term should be understood here as an interpretive framework rather than a literal finding that his social identity had been legally erased. It can help explain why housing insecurity, family estrangement, restrictions on contact, stigma, and dependence on institutions may feel like more than a series of separate practical difficulties.

The image of exile also connects the personal narrative to the spiritual framework McLean uses in his writing. Exile can represent separation from belonging; the witness can represent the person who continues to testify despite being ignored; and return can represent the restoration of voice and recognition. These meanings can be examined as philosophical and spiritual interpretations without claiming that they establish a hidden causal explanation for the events.

The witness's experience of exclusion is therefore a central theme of the manuscript. The reasons for each exclusion, the responsibility of particular individuals, and the existence or absence of any coordinated plan remain questions for the evidence.

End of Part II. The next part will continue with the NDIS and support-provider chronology, the allegation that assistance was withheld or discouraged, the roles attributed to Tony Ridley and Steve Ison, the reported surveillance and threats, and the need to distinguish direct evidence from inferred connections.

THE WITNESS AND THE STATE
Continued manuscript — Part III
Chapter 9. The NDIS, disability support, and the difference between formal entitlement and lived reality
9.1 The participant and the minister
The relationship between McLean's personal account and the National Disability Insurance Scheme is one of the central subjects of this examination. McLean describes himself as an

NDIS participant who experienced substantial hardship while seeking support, accommodation, stability, and a meaningful degree of independence. He places these experiences within the period when Bill Shorten held the federal portfolio responsible for the NDIS and government services.

The official record establishes that Shorten served as Minister for the NDIS and Government Services from 1 June 2022 until 20 January 2025. The Australian Parliament's official biography of Bill Shorten, the NDIA announcement welcoming the minister in June 2022, and the Department of Social Services statement concerning his departure from the portfolio establish the relevant public-office chronology.

The chronology matters because a minister is accountable for the administration and policy direction of a portfolio, subject to the applicable statutory framework and conventions of responsible government. It is reasonable to examine whether the scheme's administration, oversight arrangements, safeguards, and complaint mechanisms adequately protected participants during that period.

It is not reasonable, however, to treat the minister's position as proof that he personally controlled every decision affecting every participant. The NDIA, registered providers, support coordinators, health services, police, and state-based bodies have different functions and responsibilities. Their decisions may be connected through policy or referral processes, but an individual decision must be traced to the people and institutions that made it.

The proper question is therefore twofold: what did McLean experience while seeking disability support, and what evidence exists concerning the decisions and responsibilities of the agencies and individuals involved?

9.2 The meaning of an approved plan

The archive includes a document titled NDIS Plan Approval dated 20 November 2025. Its date places it after Shorten's ministerial tenure ended. It may nevertheless be relevant to the later consequences of the support history described by McLean.

An approved plan and the practical delivery of support are different things. A plan may authorise funding or specify supports, but the existence of a plan does not itself demonstrate that a suitable provider was available, that services were delivered consistently, that the participant's accommodation was safe, or that the funded arrangements met the person's actual needs.

Conversely, a participant's dissatisfaction with an arrangement does not, by itself, establish that the plan was unlawful or that a provider breached a duty. Those questions depend on the plan's terms, the participant's circumstances, the services requested, the services delivered, the applicable standards, and the reasons recorded for any refusal or interruption.

For this reason, the NDIS chronology must distinguish:

- the participant's stated support needs;
- the supports requested and the reasons for requesting them;
- the supports approved or declined;
- the practical availability of providers;
- the support actually delivered;

- any complaints, incidents, or safeguarding concerns;
- the response of the relevant agency or provider; and
- any review, reassessment, or subsequent change.

Each category should be supported by its own primary record wherever possible.

9.3 Supported independent living and specialist disability accommodation

McLean's archive contains a document titled NDIA decision concerning a SIL request dated 1 June 2023, as well as a later SIL/SDA accommodation request dated 20 January 2026.

The two records are separated by more than two and a half years. If they concern the same participant and a continuing need for suitable accommodation, their relationship may be important. The actual documents must establish whether the later request arose from the same needs, a changed situation, a new assessment, or another set of circumstances.

Supported independent living and specialist disability accommodation are not interchangeable concepts. A request for support with daily living, a request for a particular accommodation arrangement, and a request for funding under a specific NDIS category may raise different questions. The assessment must identify exactly what was sought and what decision was made.

The critical issues include whether the decision-maker considered the relevant evidence, whether the stated reasons corresponded to the participant's circumstances, whether alternatives were proposed, whether the participant understood any review rights, and whether the resulting arrangements were practically workable.

If McLean was left without a suitable option despite making documented requests, that would be important to establish. It would not automatically prove that the same person or institution caused every subsequent hardship. The documentary chain must identify the specific decision, its effect, and any available link to later events.

9.4 The role of providers and support coordinators

McLean says that he sought accommodation and assistance from NDIS providers but believes that some providers were unwilling or unable to help him. He interprets this as part of a larger pattern of exclusion. He further suspects that some providers may have been discouraged from assisting him by people with greater institutional influence.

The experience of being unable to secure support can be profoundly destabilising, especially where accommodation, daily living, transport, finances, and access to other services depend on reliable arrangements. A provider's refusal, withdrawal, or failure to deliver a service can have consequences extending beyond the immediate service transaction.

The reasons for an individual provider's decision, however, must be established. A provider may lack capacity, consider a requested service outside its scope, have concerns about staffing or risk, disagree about funding, or make a decision for reasons that require scrutiny. Some reasons may be legitimate; others may warrant complaint or investigation. The existence of a refusal alone does not establish which explanation applies.

To examine McLean's account, the records should identify the provider, the service requested, the date of the request, the response, any written reasons, the applicable service agreement, the funding position, and any communications about the decision. If a provider

was contacted by a government official or another third party, the relevant communication would be central evidence. Without it, a claim that assistance was deliberately blocked by an external authority remains an allegation rather than a finding.

The archive includes a formal notice concerning alleged NDIS service failure dated 20 January 2026, a housing letter concerning SIL accommodation, and an emergency accommodation and safety assessment. These are potentially important sources for establishing what McLean reported, what help he sought, and what risks or needs were communicated. Their contents and any subsequent responses must be inspected before stronger conclusions are drawn.

9.5 Salman Ceri and the reported assistance with a car

McLean refers to a provider or support figure named Salman Ceri and says that this person helped him purchase a car. The significance of that assistance should be examined on its own terms.

The investigation should establish the nature of the relationship, the date and circumstances of the assistance, whether money was lent or provided, who owned the vehicle, whether a written agreement existed, and whether the assistance was connected to an NDIS service arrangement. The car may have represented practical independence, access to appointments, or a means of leaving an unsafe or unsuitable living situation.

The fact that one person assisted McLean would not prove that the person participated in, or was excluded from, any larger alleged campaign. Likewise, later conflict or disagreement would not establish that the earlier assistance was insincere.

If the car later became the subject of a financial or guardianship decision, that decision should be documented separately. The archive's NSW Trustee vehicle disposal decision dated 14 November 2025 is a possible source to inspect, but its relationship to the earlier purchase must not be assumed from the filename.

9.6 A fair assessment of support-system responsibility

The central ethical issue is not whether an individual participant should be believed without examination or whether a service provider should be presumed at fault. It is whether the system had workable mechanisms for identifying unmet needs, resolving disputes, maintaining continuity of support, and protecting a participant who was vulnerable to homelessness or serious hardship.

If the records show that McLean repeatedly communicated an urgent need for assistance, those communications should be examined for what they requested, when they were sent, whether they reached the responsible office, and what action followed. If an agency acknowledged a problem but did not act, the evidence should identify the acknowledgement and the omission. If a request was declined for stated reasons, those reasons should be assessed against the applicable requirements.

The moral and administrative questions are distinct but connected. A decision can be formally valid yet have severe practical consequences. A participant can experience real distress even where an agency acted within its authority. And a decision may warrant review if the reasons, process, or practical effects reveal a failure to consider relevant

circumstances.
The documentary method must preserve all three possibilities until the records justify a conclusion.

Chapter 10. The allegations of blocked assistance and coordinated exclusion

10.1 The account of providers being discouraged from helping

McLean believes that, after a period of worsening circumstances, his attempts to obtain accommodation and support were obstructed by forces beyond the individual providers with whom he dealt. He has described the possibility that people with political or institutional influence discouraged providers from assisting him, whether through explicit instructions, informal pressure, financial consequences, or reputational concerns.
This is an important allegation because it proposes a causal relationship between separate decisions. It is also a claim that requires a particularly careful evidentiary test.
The fact that several providers declined to assist the same participant could indicate a common cause, but the cause might take different forms. The providers could independently lack capacity. They could have received the same incomplete information. They could have concerns about the suitability of a requested service. They could be responding to funding limitations or other constraints. Alternatively, there could have been an improper communication or pressure affecting their decisions. The pattern alone does not determine which explanation is correct.
A proper inquiry would therefore create a table of each provider interaction, recording the date, service sought, decision, explanation, and evidence of any external contact. The records should then be compared for distinctive similarities, shared wording, unusual timing, or explicit references to another person or authority. Similar outcomes may justify further investigation, but a common cause should not be declared without evidence linking the cases.

10.2 The distinction between systemic failure and deliberate coordination

The concept of systemic failure describes a pattern in which processes, incentives, responsibilities, or safeguards repeatedly produce poor outcomes. It does not necessarily imply that every person involved intended the result.
Deliberate coordination is a more specific proposition. It implies that two or more people communicated or acted together toward a shared purpose. To establish it, the evidence would need to show more than the fact that several adverse events occurred. It would need to identify the relevant participants, the communication or conduct linking them, the purpose reasonably indicated by that evidence, and the relationship between the coordination and the events under examination.
This distinction is essential to the manuscript. McLean’s experience may reveal a serious pattern of unmet needs or failed accountability even if no evidence emerges of a centrally coordinated campaign. A finding of poor service, inadequate communication, an unreasonable decision, or a failed complaint process does not require proof of a conspiracy. Conversely, a claim that identifiable people deliberately coordinated harmful action requires a substantially more specific evidentiary foundation.

The investigation should not dilute an established administrative failure by insisting that deliberate malice must be proven before the failure can be criticised. Nor should it turn a series of failures into proof of deliberate coordination without the connecting evidence.

10.3 The archive as a chronology rather than a predetermined verdict

McLean's archive includes documents that he has titled in strongly accusatory terms, including "NDIS Shorten Assassination Exposed," dated 20 January 2026. The title communicates the author's interpretation and the seriousness with which he views the events. It is not, by itself, an independent finding that an assassination attempt occurred or that Shorten caused one.

A documentary examination should preserve such a document because it records the author's account and beliefs at a particular point in time. It should then separate the document's assertions from the underlying sources it cites. If it reproduces an official record, the official record should be linked directly. If it quotes a message, the original message should be located where possible. If it draws an inference, the evidence supporting that inference should be stated. If it contains a spiritual interpretation, that interpretation should be identified as such.

The archive's value is strongest when readers can move from a conclusion back to the evidence that supports it. The more serious the allegation, the more important that chain becomes.

10.4 What evidence would establish improper pressure?

The investigation should look for direct evidence of a communication or decision that cannot be explained solely by ordinary provider discretion. Relevant material could include emails, text messages, provider notes, meeting records, call logs, formal referrals, instructions, funding correspondence, or testimony from a person who directly witnessed the communication.

The absence of a document in the publicly accessible archive would not prove that the communication never occurred. It would mean only that the claim has not been substantiated by that particular collection. A source may exist elsewhere, be held by another party, be inaccessible for legal reasons, or never have been created. These possibilities should be distinguished.

Likewise, the appearance of a document with a suggestive filename does not establish the truth of its contents. The author, date, provenance, and complete text matter. Where a document contains an allegation, the manuscript should identify who made it and what corroboration is available.

The current evidence available for this chapter establishes that McLean has preserved and published documents relating to his requests for assistance and his allegations of institutional failure. It does not independently establish that Shorten, a government office, or a group of providers directed a coordinated effort to prevent him from receiving accommodation.

That is a limit on the present finding, not a declaration that McLean's account is false.

Chapter 11. Tony Ridley: relationship, alleged threats, and the question of corroboration

11.1 The relationship described by McLean

McLean describes a personal relationship with Tony Ridley and attributes to Ridley a background that he says included fraud investigation and former military service. He further alleges that Ridley was involved in exposing a substantial fraud and that the relationship later became hostile.

These biographical claims must be verified independently before they are presented as facts. A person's name, alleged occupation, military history, or investigative role should not be repeated as established merely because it appears in another person's account. The appropriate sources may include reliable public records, authenticated correspondence, contemporaneous documents, or direct testimony that can be assessed for credibility and context.

McLean also says that he and Ridley had a sexual relationship and that a recording was published to YouTube, which McLean understood as a form of protection for both parties. The existence, content, date, and circumstances of any recording would need to be established through the original material and its metadata where available. The manuscript should avoid unnecessary disclosure of intimate information that is not needed to assess the public-interest questions.

The relationship itself may be relevant to understanding McLean's chronology, trust, and later fears. It does not establish that Ridley was connected to Shorten or to any alleged government action. That connection requires separate evidence.

11.2 The allegations of threats and surveillance

McLean says that Ridley later became an enemy and that he experienced years of threats, electronic surveillance, and what he describes as gang stalking. He also reports experiences that he calls V2K, a term often used to refer to alleged "voice-to-skull" communications. These reports must be handled with both seriousness and precision. McLean's report establishes that he experienced and described the events as threatening. The objective source of the perceived communications, the identity of any person responsible, and the means by which they allegedly occurred are separate questions.

If McLean possesses messages containing explicit threats, the original messages should be preserved with dates, sender information, full context, and available metadata. If he alleges that his phone or vehicle was monitored, relevant technical evidence should be distinguished from suspicions about what might have happened. Independent forensic examination may be necessary to determine whether a device shows evidence of compromise or whether a vehicle was fitted with a tracking device.

An experience that feels invasive or frightening should not be dismissed solely because its explanation is uncertain. But the experience alone cannot establish who caused it. In particular, the fact that a person reports surveillance does not establish that a particular politician, police service, former partner, or other identifiable individual was responsible.

11.3 The alleged connection to Shorten

McLean's account proposes that Ridley knew of, participated in, or was connected to efforts to silence him, and that Shorten was aware of or involved in those efforts. The seriousness of

that claim requires a clearly identified chain of evidence.

The investigation should separate the propositions:

- McLean and Ridley had a relationship.
- The relationship later deteriorated.
- McLean received or experienced what he understood as threats.
- The threats can be attributed to Ridley.
- Ridley communicated with Shorten or someone acting on Shorten's behalf.
- That communication concerned McLean.
- The communication led to a particular act affecting McLean.

Each proposition requires its own support. Evidence for the first two would not automatically establish the third or fourth. Evidence that two people knew each other would not establish that they coordinated a particular action. Even proof of communication would not, without its content and context, establish a shared purpose.

The archive should be searched for original correspondence, recordings, messages, public statements, and other records that bear directly on these propositions. Where the material is authored by McLean, it should be cited as his account. Where independent records exist, they should be linked separately.

Until the connecting evidence is established, the alleged relationship between Ridley and Shorten must remain unresolved.

11.4 The moral question of trust

The relationship described by McLean is significant because it involves a movement from intimacy and trust to fear and suspicion. That movement can shape how a person interprets later events, especially when other areas of life are already unstable.

The manuscript should not assume that the earlier intimacy proves the later allegations, nor that the later allegations erase the significance of the earlier relationship. Both can be part of the person's account. What remains necessary is to distinguish the facts of the relationship from the claims made about later conduct.

A documentary examination can preserve that complexity without turning an unverified accusation into a finding about another person's character.

Chapter 12. Steve Ison: former partnership, employment, financial allegations, and the limits of inference

12.1 The relationship and its later deterioration

McLean identifies Steve Ison as a former partner and as someone with whom he also had a working relationship. He describes the relationship as lasting approximately five years and alleges that Ison exploited him, later abandoned him, and may have been involved in financial misconduct.

These are allegations concerning an identifiable person. They must be tied to the underlying evidence and should not be presented as established criminal conduct without a reliable finding or sufficiently corroborated records.

The initial task is to establish the relationship and its timeline: when the parties met, the nature of the personal relationship, the nature of the employment or business arrangement, the duties each person undertook, the financial transactions involved, and the circumstances

in which the relationship ended. Employment records, contracts, invoices, bank statements, messages, and contemporaneous correspondence may be relevant.

Where personal and professional relationships overlap, a dispute can involve several different questions. A relationship may end painfully without a crime having occurred. A financial disagreement may involve a debt or contractual dispute rather than fraud. Conversely, a close relationship does not prevent genuine misconduct from occurring. The proper classification depends on the evidence.

12.2 The alleged million-dollar fraud message

McLean refers to a message that he understood as indicating that Ison was associated with a million-dollar fraud. The exact wording, author, date, context, and provenance of that message are essential.

The manuscript should not repeat the allegation as a fact unless the original message and independent evidence support it. Even an authentic message containing an accusation establishes first that the author made the accusation; it does not automatically establish the underlying fraud.

The relevant questions are:

- Who wrote or sent the message?
- Was the sender in a position to know the facts?
- What transaction or conduct did the message describe?
- Did it refer to an actual investigation, a suspicion, a rumour, or a hypothetical amount?
- Is there independent documentary evidence of the alleged transaction?
- Was any regulator, court, or law-enforcement body involved?
- Was there a formal finding, charge, judgment, or other verified outcome?

If no reliable evidence beyond the message exists, the manuscript should describe it as an allegation recorded in a message, not as proof of fraud.

12.3 The alleged threat concerning the dog

McLean also says that Ison wanted to kill his dog. This is a serious claim, and its presentation must depend on what the evidence actually shows.

If the statement appears in a message, the original should be reproduced accurately and linked to its source, subject to any privacy or safety considerations. The surrounding conversation matters. A threatening statement, an ambiguous remark, a third-party report, and a later recollection are different kinds of evidence.

The manuscript should state what the original material says and how McLean interpreted it. If the words are not available, the account should remain explicitly attributed to him.

12.4 The proposed connection to a larger campaign

McLean believes that Ison's actions were connected to those of Ridley and Shorten. This proposed connection must be investigated separately from the allegations about the former partnership and financial dispute.

The existence of relationships between people, or the fact that several conflicts occurred within a similar period, does not prove that the people coordinated their actions. A defensible claim of coordination requires evidence of communication, shared purpose, or conduct that is difficult to explain without such a connection.

If the archive contains messages involving more than one of these individuals, the complete messages and their chronology should be compared. The analysis should identify direct communications, references to third parties, independently corroborated events, and alternative explanations. It should not infer a common plan merely because the resulting events caused similar distress.

The proper conclusion at this stage is that McLean reports a former personal and working relationship that ended in conflict, and he has alleged financial misconduct and a threat involving his dog. The specific allegations and the proposed connection to other individuals require primary evidence and independent verification.

Chapter 13. The reported contact involving Ben, the alleged assassination attempt, and the need to establish the record

13.1 The reported statement

McLean describes a conversation or communication involving a person named Ben. According to McLean, the information attributed to Ben included a statement to the effect that "Bill wants to know if you're mentally ready to challenge him in a court as he might use his history of mental illness as an excuse to discredit your story."

This wording is reproduced here as a reported quotation from McLean's account, not as a verified statement by Shorten or an authenticated statement by Ben. The original message or recording has not been examined in the material available for this section.

The provenance of the statement is central. The investigation must establish who Ben was, how the communication occurred, whether the words were recorded contemporaneously, whether the quotation is exact, and whether Ben identified the source of the information. It must also distinguish what Ben personally knew from what he may have heard from someone else.

If the statement is authenticated, it could be relevant to the question of whether McLean was warned that his mental-health history might be raised in a dispute. It would not automatically establish that Shorten made the statement, authorised it, or intended to discredit McLean. Those are separate propositions requiring separate evidence.

13.2 The allegation of an assassination attempt

McLean says that he experienced what he understood to be an assassination attempt and that police later confirmed the event was real and a close call. He also describes an alleged report that he believes was intended to damage his reputation.

These claims must be separated into distinct questions. Was there an identifiable physical incident? Was it reported to police? Was it investigated? Did police record a threat, an assault, an attempted offence, or another event? Did an officer make a finding, offer an opinion, or simply record what a person reported? Was there a charge or court outcome? What evidence links the incident to any named individual?

The phrase assassination attempt carries a specific implication of deliberate, potentially lethal action against a targeted person. It should not be used as an established description unless the evidence supports that conclusion. Where the underlying event is uncertain, the manuscript should use a more precise description of the documented conduct.

The archive contains a document titled "NDIS Shorten Assassination Exposed," dated 20 January 2026. The title records the author's interpretation of the event. It does not independently prove that an assassination attempt occurred or that Shorten was responsible.

The relevant primary sources would include any police event report, witness statement, contemporaneous messages, medical records arising from the incident, forensic evidence, and any official correspondence explaining the investigation's outcome. If a police officer told McLean that the incident was a close call, the precise words, circumstances, and any written record should be established before that statement is attributed to the police service as an official finding.

13.3 The reported encounter with Debbie Morgan

McLean also refers to an encounter with Debbie Morgan, which he describes as consensual at the time but later regretted. He alleges that a subsequent report about the encounter was false or was used to damage his reputation.

The account contains several distinct matters: the encounter itself, the question of consent, the later report, the investigation undertaken, and McLean's allegation concerning the report's truthfulness or motivation. Each requires careful treatment.

A person's later regret does not, by itself, establish that an earlier encounter was non-consensual. Equally, an assertion that an encounter was consensual cannot be treated as a definitive finding without examining the evidence relevant to the specific allegation. The legal and factual questions depend on the conduct alleged, the applicable law, and the available evidence.

McLean's claim that a report was fabricated or that someone was paid to make it is a further allegation. It should not be presented as fact without evidence of fabrication, payment, or an official finding. If the relevant police or investigative record exists, it should be examined in its entirety, including the allegation made, the evidence considered, the outcome, and the reasons recorded.

McLean says that he understood the Australian Federal Police to have treated the encounter as consensual or non-criminal. That description must be checked against the actual AFP correspondence. A decision not to take action, a finding that an event did not meet a particular criminal threshold, and a positive finding that an allegation was false are not equivalent. The exact words of the agency's response matter.

13.4 The risk of combining separate events

McLean places the reported statement, the alleged assassination attempt, the encounter with Morgan, and his broader concerns about police and reputation within a single narrative of persecution. That is how he understands the events. The documentary analysis must determine whether the available evidence supports the connections he proposes.

An event may be real without the witness's proposed explanation being established. A police report may contain an inaccurate statement without proving that the author deliberately fabricated it. A person may be treated unfairly without that unfairness having been directed by a minister. These distinctions do not diminish the importance of investigating specific

errors or misconduct. They prevent one unresolved claim from being used as proof of another.

The investigation should create an event-by-event chronology, identify the source of each statement, and establish which facts have independent corroboration. Where a link between events is inferred rather than directly documented, that inference should be labelled and its reasoning explained.

The current conclusion is limited: McLean reports an alarming incident, a statement attributed through another person, and concerns about a later report and its effect on his reputation. The claims of an assassination attempt, deliberate fabrication, payment, and political coordination require direct documentary support before they can be presented as established findings.

Chapter 14. Surveillance, V2K, and the distinction between an experience and its explanation

14.1 Preserving the account without prejudging its cause

McLean has described experiences that he interprets as electronic surveillance, communications he calls V2K, and coordinated following or harassment. These experiences form part of his account of why he felt unsafe and why he came to suspect that multiple people were acting together.

A serious documentary examination should preserve the account accurately. It should record when the experiences began, what was perceived, what the witness directly observed, what was inferred, what contemporaneous records exist, and what explanations have been considered. It should not dismiss the account solely because the explanation is disputed. Nor should it state that the alleged technology, surveillance, or coordination has been established without independent evidence.

The distinction is straightforward but essential: the report of an experience is one evidentiary fact; the identity of its cause is another. A person can sincerely report hearing something, noticing an unfamiliar vehicle, receiving a threatening message, or believing a device has been monitored. Whether the experience was caused by a particular person or technology requires further evidence.

14.2 Technical evidence and independent examination

If the claim concerns a phone, computer, online account, or vehicle, the relevant evidence may include device logs, account-security records, authenticated messages, location data, forensic findings, or records of unauthorised access. Each source has limitations. A suspicious login may demonstrate access from an unfamiliar location but may not identify the individual responsible. A device malfunction may have several possible causes. A message received from an unknown account may establish that a message was sent, but not necessarily the sender’s real-world identity.

A credible examination should preserve original files and metadata, document how the material was obtained, avoid altering the source, and distinguish forensic findings from speculation. If a qualified examiner has assessed a device, the report should identify the examiner’s qualifications, methods, findings, and limitations.

If no technical evidence is available, the manuscript should state that the allegation remains unverified rather than inventing a forensic explanation.

14.3 The moral obligation not to humiliate the witness

A person's mental-health history should not be used as a substitute for examining evidence. The fact that a person has received psychiatric treatment does not automatically make a statement false. Equally, the sincerity or intensity of a belief does not independently establish the objective truth of the explanation attached to it.

The ethical obligation is to treat the person with dignity while applying consistent evidentiary standards. That means neither ridicule nor automatic endorsement. It means asking what happened, what the person directly observed, what records exist, what independent sources say, and what remains uncertain.

In McLean's case, this standard is especially important because he says he fears that his history of mental illness could be used to discredit him. The proper response is not to presume that his account is either true or false because of that history. It is to assess each claim on its own evidence.

Chapter 15. The comparative ethical examination: the individual witness and the institution

15.1 Two different kinds of power

The comparison at the centre of this manuscript is between an individual who describes himself as vulnerable, excluded, and struggling to obtain assistance, and institutions that possess formal authority, professional resources, and established decision-making procedures.

This is not a comparison between two equivalent entities. A government department can make administrative decisions, retain records, communicate through official channels, and rely on legal and policy expertise. A person who lacks stable accommodation, financial resources, or consistent support may have fewer practical means to challenge a decision or preserve evidence. A minister also has public responsibilities that an individual participant does not possess.

That asymmetry is a legitimate subject for ethical and political analysis. It does not mean that the individual is always correct or that the institution is always wrong. It means that the consequences of decisions, the ability to contest them, and the responsibility to explain them may be distributed unequally.

15.2 The ethical attributes of the witness

McLean presents his continued documentation as an act of persistence. He has assembled records, written personal statements, sought explanations, and attempted to construct a coherent account of events that he regards as connected. He frames this activity through the language of witness, exile, betrayal, survival, and spiritual restoration.

The ethical strengths potentially associated with such an approach include persistence, a commitment to preserving records, willingness to make claims publicly, and a demand that institutions explain their decisions. These are qualities to examine in the conduct and documentary record, rather than automatically conferred moral status.

The same scrutiny applies to the witness's interpretations. A commitment to truth requires willingness to distinguish evidence from inference, acknowledge uncertainty, correct errors, and revise conclusions when the record warrants it. The strength of a witness is not measured solely by how forcefully an allegation is stated. It is also measured by whether the account remains open to verification.

This does not demand emotional neutrality from a person describing painful experiences. It requires a documentary distinction between the person's emotional truth—what the events meant to them—and the factual propositions that can be established independently.

15.3 The ethical responsibilities of institutions

Institutions should be assessed against the responsibilities attached to their actual roles. Relevant standards may include legality, procedural fairness, transparency, accountability, proportionality, respect for dignity, protection of personal information, and access to review. A department should be able to explain the basis of an administrative decision. A provider should be able to explain a refusal or interruption of service where required. A police service should be able to account for the legal basis of coercive action. A health service should record the reasons and authority for restrictive interventions. A legal service should be capable of explaining what advice was provided and what options were available to a client. These are general standards, not findings that a particular agency breached them. A specific conclusion requires evidence identifying the responsible institution, the applicable duty, the action or omission, and the relevant facts.

The comparison becomes meaningful when it moves from rhetoric to conduct. If a decision was unsupported, unexplained, or procedurally unfair, the evidence should identify the defect. If the institution acted lawfully and gave adequate reasons, that conclusion should also be recorded, even if the result was distressing. The purpose is accountability, not a predetermined verdict.

15.4 Why the comparison must not become a personality contest

McLean's earlier instructions seek a comparative examination of the moral attributes of the individual witness and the state or its representatives. Such an examination can be useful if it evaluates specific conduct against transparent ethical criteria. It becomes unreliable if it attempts to diagnose character from disputed allegations or declare one party inherently good and another inherently evil.

The state is not a single personality. It is a collection of institutions, statutory powers, decision-makers, professional duties, and administrative processes. A minister's public conduct should be assessed through public records and verified decisions. A police officer's conduct should be assessed through the relevant event and evidence. A provider's conduct should be assessed through its service obligations and actions. The individual witness should be assessed through the consistency and corroboration of specific claims, without reducing the person to a label.

The strongest comparison is therefore between demonstrated conduct and a declared standard. It asks whether the action was honest, fair, proportionate, transparent, and accountable. It does not assume that a person's institutional position proves corruption or

that a person's vulnerability proves innocence.

Chapter 16. The theological framework: witness, crucifixion, resurrection, redemption, and the limits of proof

16.1 The chosen witness as a spiritual identity

McLean's writing uses the idea of the chosen witness to interpret his experience of suffering, exclusion, and survival. Within that framework, the witness is the person who continues to testify even when recognition is denied, the record is disputed, and the social environment feels hostile. The figure draws on biblical traditions in which testimony, endurance, suffering, truth, and hope are connected.

The phrase chosen witness has spiritual meaning for McLean. It should be preserved as part of his self-understanding, not converted into an externally established fact that a supernatural force selected him for a particular political or historical role. An impartial examination can analyse what the concept means to him, how it shapes his writing, and how it relates to biblical traditions without claiming authority to verify a divine mandate.

This distinction protects both the spiritual integrity of the account and the credibility of the documentary investigation. Faith can provide a framework for interpreting suffering. It does not substitute for evidence about who made a particular decision or why an event occurred.

16.2 Crucifixion as a metaphor for public humiliation and exclusion

In Christian theology, crucifixion refers centrally to the execution of Jesus Christ. In literary and philosophical interpretation, the image can also be used metaphorically to describe humiliation, abandonment, public condemnation, or a situation in which a person feels exposed to the power of others.

McLean employs this language to describe what he experiences as social erasure, the loss of recognition, and a struggle to remain present in the public record. The metaphor communicates the seriousness of his experience without establishing that his circumstances are literally equivalent to the crucifixion of Jesus or that any particular person occupies the role of a biblical persecutor.

The ethical question raised by the metaphor is whether a society can inflict profound harm through exclusion, neglect, stigma, or the denial of a meaningful opportunity to respond. The answer depends on the particular conduct and evidence. The metaphor can help articulate the moral stakes, but the documentary analysis must still identify what occurred and who was responsible.

16.3 Resurrection as restoration and continued testimony

Resurrection is central to Christian belief concerning Jesus Christ. In McLean's writing, the concept also functions as a symbol of survival, renewed voice, and the refusal to allow an account of suffering to disappear.

A public archive can serve as a practical expression of that symbolism. Documents are preserved, links are maintained, and statements can be revisited after the original event. The act of preservation can resist the disappearance of a person's account from public memory.

But the survival of a document is not proof that every assertion in it is correct. The continued publication of an allegation does not independently corroborate it. The strongest form of

documentary resurrection is not the repetition of a claim until it appears certain; it is the preservation of the original evidence so that future examination remains possible.

16.4 Redemption, confession, and moral repair

Redemption can mean restoration after wrongdoing, suffering, or estrangement. Confession can mean the acknowledgement of responsibility, the disclosure of truth, or the admission of a moral failure. In legal and religious settings, the terms have different meanings and consequences.

McLean's narrative raises the question of what accountability would require if an institution or individual had caused harm. Possible forms of repair might include acknowledging an error, correcting a record, explaining a decision, restoring access to a service, compensating a person where legally justified, or changing a process to prevent recurrence.

These are possibilities, not assumptions that wrongdoing has already been established. Redemption should not be used to force a predetermined confession from a named person. A legitimate demand for accountability must identify the act, the duty, the evidence, and the remedy sought.

16.5 Heaven, hell, darkness, and light

Heaven and hell, in their religious traditions, refer to ultimate spiritual realities whose meanings differ across theological interpretations. In a documentary narrative, they can also function as metaphors for hope and despair, belonging and exclusion, relief and suffering. Darkness and light can similarly symbolise concealment and disclosure, confusion and understanding, or fear and hope.

McLean's language of darkness and light frames the archive as a struggle to bring hidden or neglected matters into view. That is a legitimate literary and spiritual interpretation. It does not establish that every unanswered question conceals deliberate wrongdoing, or that everyone who disputes the witness's interpretation represents evil.

The moral value of light is most clearly expressed through transparency: original documents, accurate quotations, clear chronology, open uncertainty, and the willingness to correct errors. Darkness, in the documentary sense, can also arise from incomplete records, inaccessible decisions, ambiguous wording, or gaps in the evidence. Those gaps may warrant investigation, but they should not automatically be filled with a single explanation.

16.6 Mortality, eternity, and the urgency of the record

The concepts of mortality and eternity introduce a further dimension. Mortality concerns the limits of individual life, while eternity concerns existence beyond ordinary temporal limits in various philosophical and religious traditions. For a person who feels that their account may disappear before it is heard, the act of creating an archive can acquire unusual urgency.

A digital record may survive its author, but its survival depends on preservation, access, format, hosting, and future interpretation. The archive can preserve what McLean said, what documents he retained, and what questions he wanted answered. It cannot guarantee that every interpretation will endure or that future readers will agree with his conclusions.

The ethical obligation is therefore to leave a record that future readers can examine independently. That means preserving the evidence and its context, not only the conclusion

the author hopes readers will reach.

Chapter 17. The institutional comparison and the ethics of power

17.1 Formal authority and personal responsibility

The state exercises power through legislation, public administration, enforcement, funding decisions, and statutory institutions. Such power is not inherently abusive. It is necessary for public administration and the provision of services. Its legitimacy depends, however, on the lawfulness of its exercise, the adequacy of its reasons, and the availability of mechanisms to challenge error.

Shorten's ministerial tenure is relevant to the institutional chronology. The official parliamentary record establishes the office he held and the period in which he held it. Government documents also show that the NDIS and Government Services portfolio involved formal responsibilities concerning agencies within that portfolio. These facts justify examination of the portfolio's administration; they do not prove personal intervention in McLean's circumstances.

The distinction between political accountability and individual causation should remain explicit throughout the manuscript. A minister can be questioned about the performance of a portfolio without being accused, without evidence, of personally directing every adverse outcome within it. A portfolio may have systemic shortcomings that warrant political scrutiny even where no individual minister personally made the decision at issue.

17.2 The ethics of administrative dependency

Disability-support arrangements can create a relationship of dependency. A participant may depend on funding decisions, provider availability, support coordination, accommodation arrangements, and administrative processes that are difficult to navigate independently. Where a person lacks money or stable housing, a delay or refusal may have immediate consequences.

The ethical question is whether institutions recognise that practical dependency and respond in ways that preserve dignity and access to review. An administrative decision may be made through a formally correct process yet leave a participant with no workable alternative. That does not automatically make the decision unlawful, but it can reveal a gap between formal administration and lived reality.

A fair examination should therefore consider both the written decision and its practical effect. It should ask whether the decision-maker considered the relevant circumstances, whether the person was informed of the reasons, whether alternatives were available, and whether an effective review mechanism existed.

17.3 The ethics of public accusation

McLean's writing uses forceful language to describe what he believes happened. That language reflects the intensity of his experience and his desire for accountability. Public allegations concerning identifiable people, however, require precision because they can affect reputation, privacy, safety, and the integrity of any later investigation.

The answer is not to erase the witness's account or prohibit criticism of powerful people. It is to distinguish what is documented from what is alleged, and what is alleged from what is

inferred. A verified official finding can be described as such. A complaint should be described as a complaint. A personal account should be attributed to its author. An interpretation should be identified as an interpretation.

This approach protects the witness as well as the people named. If a claim is later challenged, a manuscript with clear source categories can demonstrate that it did not misrepresent an allegation as a proven fact. It also enables a reader to identify precisely what further evidence would be needed.

17.4 What accountability should look like

Accountability should be specific. It should identify the action or omission in question, the responsible decision-maker, the applicable standard, the evidence supporting the claim, the response from the person or institution concerned, and the remedy sought.

A general demand that an institution admit corruption is not a substitute for that process. Nor is a general denial sufficient where the evidence establishes a specific failure. The proper outcome depends on what the records demonstrate.

Where an agency made an error, the remedy may involve correction, reconsideration, explanation, or compensation under the relevant framework. Where a service was not delivered, the remedy may involve restoring support or reviewing the service arrangement. Where a complaint was not properly handled, the remedy may involve an independent review. Where allegations are not substantiated, the record should state that outcome accurately without treating the absence of proof as proof that the person who complained acted dishonestly.

The central ethical standard is that the same evidentiary discipline should apply regardless of whether the subject is a vulnerable participant, a public official, a police officer, a health professional, a provider, or a former associate.

Chapter 18. The archive as a public record: source integrity, evidence classification, and reproducibility

18.1 Preservation before interpretation

The archive’s governing principle—preservation first, examination second, conclusion last—provides a sound foundation for a documentary inquiry. The first responsibility is to retain the material in a form that can be retrieved and examined. The second is to understand what the material says and how it was created. The third is to draw conclusions limited to what the evidence supports.

This order matters because interpretation can influence how a reader sees a document before the document has been examined. A title may describe a file as proof of corruption, assassination, fabrication, or institutional conspiracy. That title communicates the author’s interpretation, but the reader still needs to inspect the underlying evidence.

A preservation archive should therefore maintain original files where possible, retain relevant metadata, record the source of each item, distinguish originals from later copies, and identify any OCR or transcription errors. If a document has been redacted, converted, or annotated, that fact should be recorded. If a file is unavailable or cannot be opened, the manuscript should say so rather than reconstruct its contents from the filename.

18.2 A practical evidence classification

For this manuscript, the following labels provide a consistent method.

Label	Meaning	Appropriate use
Official record	A document issued or maintained by an identified public body or court, subject to verification of authenticity	A dated agency decision or court order
Documented fact	A proposition directly supported by an authenticated source	A letter was sent on a recorded date
Testimony	A person's account of what they experienced or observed	McLean says he was denied assistance
Allegation	A claim of wrongdoing that has not been established by a competent finding or sufficient	McLean alleges that a person directed an improper action

	sufficient corroboration	
Inference	A conclusion drawn from a set of facts rather than stated directly by a source	Similar decisions may share a common cause
Interpretation	A moral, political, psychological, or literary explanation of events	The experience is described as social exile
Spiritual belief	A religious or spiritual proposition held by the author	The author interprets survival as a form of resurrection
Unresolved	A question for which the available evidence does not support a firm conclusion	Whether two individuals communicated about a particular event

These categories are not a hierarchy of human worth. Testimony is not worthless because it is testimony. An official document is not infallible because it is official. The labels identify the kind of claim being made and the kind of examination required.

18.3 Source hierarchy and the underlying document

Where a primary document exists, it should be linked directly rather than relying only on an

index, summary, or later commentary. An index can help locate a record; it cannot substitute for the record itself.

The preferred source hierarchy is:

- The original document or authenticated copy.
- The official decision, correspondence, court record, or source record directly relevant to the claim.
- A contemporaneous message or note with sufficient provenance to assess its reliability.
- A later account by a person who participated in or observed the event.
- An index, catalogue, or archive entry identifying the document.
- A later interpretation or commentary that describes the event.

This hierarchy is a guide rather than an inflexible rule. A contemporaneous note may be incomplete; an official record may repeat an unverified statement; a later account may contain information absent from the original file. The source must be evaluated for the particular proposition it is being used to support.

18.4 The problem of duplicated documents

The archive contains documents whose filenames indicate multiple versions of certain records, including several Goulburn Hospital CEO briefings and multiple FOI decision or release files. Multiple copies may reflect revised decisions, separate releases, duplicates, or versions with different attachments.

The manuscript should not count each file as an independent corroborating source unless their independence is established. Two copies of the same document do not provide two independent confirmations. A revised decision may be significant because it changes the earlier position, but the change must be identified from the actual texts.

A document register should therefore record each file's exact title, date, author or issuing body, version, relationship to other files, and substantive relevance. Where a revised version supersedes an earlier one, the relationship should be stated.

18.5 Reproducibility and the public reader

A credible public archive should allow another person to follow the reasoning without needing to accept the author's conclusion in advance. Each material claim should be linked to the relevant source. The text should explain what the source establishes and what it does not establish. Quotations should be accurate, page references should be verified, and uncertainty should be visible.

For this reason, this manuscript does not assign invented page numbers or quotations to documents that have not been examined. The links supplied above identify relevant files in the public archive, but their complete contents have not all been independently inspected for this writing. They are included as retrieval paths, not as blanket confirmation of the allegations discussed.

This limitation must remain explicit until the underlying files are read and the relevant passages are identified. The archive can support a detailed investigation, but the presence of a document is not equivalent to a completed forensic analysis of its contents.

Chapter 19. What the current record establishes—and what remains open

19.1 Established contextual facts

The available official sources establish that Bill Shorten held the NDIS and Government Services ministerial portfolio from 1 June 2022 until 20 January 2025. This provides the public-office chronology relevant to McLean's account. It does not establish that Shorten personally directed police, hospital staff, providers, insurers, or family members in relation to McLean.

The publicly accessible Barrandodger repository contains a substantial collection of materials relating to McLean's documentary project. The filenames identify records concerning public-interest disclosures, Ombudsman complaints, NDIS decisions, accommodation requests, safety assessments, guardianship, hospital correspondence, and police-related matters. Those filenames establish the presence of a documentary collection, not the truth of every proposition made in the documents.

The archive also contains authored papers with strongly interpretive titles. These are relevant to understanding McLean's evolving account and the conclusions he has drawn. They must be distinguished from independent official findings.

19.2 Matters reported by McLean

McLean reports that he experienced severe financial hardship, difficulty obtaining support, conflict in personal relationships, family estrangement, police involvement, hospitalisation, uncertainty about legal representation, and prolonged efforts to obtain institutional responses. He describes these events as connected and interprets them through the language of targeting, exile, social death, and the chosen witness.

His testimony should be preserved in its own terms. It is relevant evidence of what he says occurred, how he understood the events, and the consequences he experienced. Where the events can be checked against contemporaneous records, those records should be examined and cited.

19.3 Allegations requiring further substantiation

The following allegations require additional primary evidence before they can be presented as established findings:

- that Shorten personally directed or caused a particular police attendance, arrest, hospitalisation, or service-provider decision;
- that the email subject line was understood by every recipient in the way McLean intended, or that the resulting police response was unlawful;
- that a court or intervention-order process was improperly initiated or influenced by a political figure;
- that a particular lawyer failed in a professional duty;
- that named providers were instructed or pressured not to assist McLean;
- that Ridley, Ison, Shorten, or others coordinated actions against McLean;
- that a particular person was responsible for alleged surveillance or V2K experiences;
- that an assassination attempt occurred in the legally specific sense implied by that term;
- that a report involving Morgan was deliberately fabricated or that payment was made to produce it; and
- that any of these events formed part of one centrally coordinated plan.

These are not findings that the allegations are false. They are statements of what remains to be established. A fair investigation must be open to evidence that substantiates an allegation, evidence that contradicts it, and evidence that leaves the issue unresolved.

19.4 What should happen next in the documentary investigation

The next stage should focus on the primary records most directly connected to the central allegations.

First, obtain the complete email titled “Death threat to Bill Shorten,” including the message headers, body, recipients, attachments, and surrounding correspondence.

Second, retrieve the police and court records concerning the alleged attendance, arrest, charge, and Moorabbin proceedings. Establish the precise case type and outcome.

Third, examine the legal-aid correspondence and any available file notes concerning Graeme Wells.

Fourth, inspect the relevant hospital records, including any documentation of police transport, restrictive interventions, discharge, and accommodation arrangements.

Fifth, reconstruct the NDIS chronology from the original plan, decisions, service agreements, provider communications, complaints, and later accommodation requests.

Sixth, preserve and authenticate the original messages and recordings that McLean associates with Ridley, Ison, Ben, and Morgan. Do not rely solely on later descriptions of those materials.

Seventh, create a communication chronology to determine whether evidence directly links the individuals or institutions whose conduct McLean believes was coordinated.

Finally, record the outcome of each investigation separately. An unresolved allegation should not disappear from the register, but it should not be promoted to an established fact simply because no answer has yet been obtained.

Chapter 20. The witness remains: a conclusion about evidence, dignity, and accountability

The central subject of The Witness and the State is the relationship between a person’s right to tell their story and the obligation to examine the evidence that story contains. McLean has described a life shaped, in his account, by financial insecurity, disability-related dependence, family estrangement, conflict with individuals he once trusted, interactions with police and health services, and a continuing effort to obtain explanations from institutions.

The archive represents his attempt to preserve that account. Its documents, letters, complaints, decisions, and personal statements provide a starting point for a more systematic examination. The archive’s importance lies not in the assumption that every allegation it contains is proven, but in the possibility that the underlying records can be inspected, compared, and tested.

The public record establishes Shorten’s ministerial role during a defined period. That fact makes the portfolio relevant to an examination of NDIS policy and administration. It does not, by itself, establish that Shorten personally caused the events McLean describes. The distinction is essential because public accountability depends on identifying the actual decision, the responsible person or institution, the applicable duty, and the evidence

supporting the claim.

The same standard applies to the police, courts, health services, providers, insurers, legal services, and private individuals named in McLean's account. Their decisions should not be presumed correct merely because they were made by an authority or professional. Nor should they be condemned without sufficient evidence. The proper course is to preserve the record, identify the relevant source, examine its contents, and state the conclusion at the level of certainty the evidence supports.

McLean's spiritual language adds another dimension. He interprets his continued survival and documentation through the figure of the chosen witness and the themes of crucifixion, resurrection, exile, and redemption. Those ideas express how he makes sense of suffering and seeks to recover a sense of voice and purpose. They can be examined as theological and philosophical interpretations without being treated as proof of a particular supernatural mandate or of a hidden political arrangement.

The concept of resurrection, in this documentary context, can be understood as the restoration of a record to public view. A document preserved today may allow a later reader to question a decision, correct an error, or understand a dispute that was previously difficult to reconstruct. But preservation must be accompanied by honesty about the limits of the material. A source should not be asked to prove more than it says, and an unanswered question should not be disguised as a settled conclusion.

The witness remains, therefore, not because every allegation has already been established, but because the right to document an experience and seek accountability does not depend on winning every disputed question in advance. The archive remains open to scrutiny. The institutions and individuals named in the account remain entitled to accurate description and fair assessment. The claims remain subject to verification. The questions that cannot yet be answered must remain visible.

The final measure of the project will be whether a reader can follow the evidence without being compelled to accept the author's interpretation, and whether the author's account can be examined without being dismissed merely because it is difficult, painful, or contested.

Preservation first. Examination second. Conclusion last.

The record stays free. Faith is not a finding.

Not a court. Not a verdict.

The witness remains—and the examination must continue.

Source register for the manuscript so far

The following links are the principal retrieval paths used in Parts I–III. They are not a claim that every PDF has been fully read or independently authenticated.

Official sources

- Australian Parliament — Bill Shorten's parliamentary biography
- NDIA — announcement welcoming the Minister for the NDIS and Government Services
- Department of Social Services — ministerial statement dated 16 January 2025

Archive and administrative records

- Main Barrandodger repository
- Main public archive website

- Rebuild website
- Official Government Documents Register
- Commonwealth Ombudsman complaint dated 15 November 2021
- Federal Court PID assessment dated 27 March 2023
- Notification of decision not to allocate a disclosure dated 18 June 2023
- NDIA SIL decision dated 1 June 2023
- NDIA CEO correspondence dated 7 January 2024, as titled in the archive
- NDIS plan approval dated 20 November 2025
- Anglicare safety assessment dated 1 December 2025
- Formal notice concerning alleged NDIS service failure dated 20 January 2026
- SIL/SDA accommodation request dated 20 January 2026
- Police matter legal documents dated 20 January 2026
- “NDIS Shorten Assassination Exposed,” dated 20 January 2026
- NSW Trustee vehicle disposal decision dated 14 November 2025
- Goulburn Hospital CEO briefing dated 11 November 2025

Important completion note: This is a substantial continuation of the manuscript, not a verified 50,000-word edition. The exact email, full police and court file, legal-aid records, and underlying messages central to several allegations still need direct examination before the manuscript can honestly claim comprehensive source verification.